AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Faculty of Business Studies

BUS629
International Business

Midterm Examination/Form C

2025-2026 / Summer

3 – August – 2026

Number of Exam Pages: 3 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed:** **2 hours**

STRUCTIONS:

1- Take **FIVE** (5) minutes to read all instructions carefully before attempting to write.
2- Mobile phones must be in "SWITCHED **OFF**" mode throughout the examination.
3- This is a **CLOSED** book examination. NO documents of any kind are allowed.
- You **MUST** answer the questions using only the answer booklets provided.
- You **MUST** return the examination paper together with your answer booklets.
- Do **NOT** write your answers in pencil except graphs/sketches.
- Students are **NOT** allowed to use any type of dictionary or mobile phones during the examinatic
Students are allowed to use ***non-programmable*** calculators only (if needed).
Any form of cheating will **NOT** be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Policy.

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YOU HAVE TO ANSWER ALL QUESTIONS IN ESSAY FORMAT.

Question 1. Imagine you have been hired as a manager in a multinational company that is expanding its operations globally. Your management asks you to prepare a report explaining the concept of globalization and the main factors driving it today. They want you to highlight the roles of important international business players. **Explain the concept of globalization and describe its main drivers. Discuss the roles of key players with examples.**

Guidelines to Answer Question 1:

To answer this question well, start by explaining what globalization means (5 marks). Then, talk about the main drivers of globalization (12 marks). After that, name the important people or groups involved in globalization and explain what they do (6 marks). Finally, make sure your answer is clear, easy to follow, and well organized to get (2 marks) for presentation **(Total: 25 marks)**

Question 2. Imagine you are a manager at a company facing an ethical dilemma where a major supplier is suspected of unfair labor practices. Your team is divided on whether to continue business with this supplier to maintain profits or to cut ties to uphold ethical standards. **Using ethical theories such as utilitarianism, rights theory, theory of justice, and cultural relativism, analyze how you would approach resolving this ethical dilemma. Explain how these theories guide decision-making in such situations.**

Guidelines to Answer Question 2:

To answer this question well, start by briefly explaining the ethical dilemma faced in the scenario (3 marks). Then, define and analyze all ethical theories and how they apply to the dilemma (15 marks) Finally, conclude by summarizing how these theories guide ethical decision-making and recommend a balanced approach to resolving the dilemma (5 marks). Ensure your answer is well-organized and clearly written to earn 2 marks for presentation. **Total: 25 marks**

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Question 3. You have been assigned to manage a team in a multinational company that includes employees from different nationals and subcultures. Some team members misunderstand each other's behaviors and communication styles, leading to conflicts. **Explain the concept of culture and cross-cultural literacy. Discuss how national culture, subcultures, and material culture influence workplace interactions. Using examples, describe how understanding these cultural elements can help you manage your diverse team more effectively.**

Guidelines to Answer Question 3:

To answer this question well, start by defining the concept of culture and cross-cultural literacy (6 marks). Then, discuss how national culture, subcultures, and material culture influence behaviors and interactions in the workplace, giving clear examples (10 marks). Next, explain how understanding these cultural elements helps in managing a diverse team and resolving conflicts effectively (7 marks). Finally, organize your answer clearly and write in a logical, easy-to-follow manner to earn 2 marks for presentation. **Total: 25 marks**

Question 4. You are working as an international trade assistant at a government agency. Your supervisor asks you to write a short report explaining why governments sometimes interfere in international trade, especially when dealing with other countries' imports and exports. **Explain the main reasons why governments intervene in international trade. Describe political, economic, and cultural motives for such interventions. Support your answer with examples**

Guidelines to Answer Question 4:

To answer this question well, begin by clearly explaining the general idea of government intervention in international trade (5 marks). Then, describe the political motives, economic motives and cultural motives. (15 marks) Support each motive with relevant examples from real-life trade scenarios (3 marks) Finally, ensure your answer is well-structured and written clearly for 2 marks. **Total: 25 marks**

END OF EXAM

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